KEY STAGE 3 DISCIPLINARY HISTORY • THE BRITISH EMPIRE & WORLD HISTORY

1770 – 1901

THE HISTORY OF AUSTRALIA

First Nations, Colonisation, Frontier Resistance & The Path to Federation



ARCHIVAL PLATE: The First Fleet entering Botany Bay, January 1788 • Eleven British sailing vessels carrying roughly 1,400 convicts, marines, and civilian officials cast anchor off the eastern coast of Australia, initiating more than a century of imperial colonisation, territorial dispossession, and Indigenous resistance.

HISTORICAL OVERVIEW • 1770–1901

FIVE DISCIPLINARY ENQUIRIES

For more than sixty-five thousand years, hundreds of distinct First Nations cultivated complex societies, oral songlines, and sophisticated fire-stick land management systems across the Australian continent. In 1770, Lieutenant James Cook charted the eastern coastline aboard HMS Endeavour, formally claiming the land for King George III under the convenient imperial fiction of terra nullius—declaring an inhabited continent to be "nobody's land". Eighteen years later, Governor Arthur Phillip led the First Fleet into Sydney Cove to establish a brutal penal colony, banishing British convicts to the opposite side of the globe.

What colonial authorities envisaged as an orderly agricultural outpost rapidly ignited more than a century of fierce territorial conflict known as the Frontier Wars. From the devastating introduction of smallpox and Pemulwuy's Bidjigal guerrilla resistance to the martial-law clearance of Van Diemen's Land and the 1838 Myall Creek massacre, pastoral settlement wrought profound devastation upon First Nations peoples. Yet through the 1851 Gold Rush, the democratic rebellion of the Eureka Stockade, and the 1901 Federation, First Nations survivance endured to challenge the foundational legal myths of British colonisation.

THE CANONICAL ENQUIRIES • SCHEME OF LEARNING DIRECTORY

A3 SADDLE-STITCH FORMAT

Enquiry 01	**Claiming Australia: Captain Cook, Tupaia & The Myth of Terra Nullius**	*Why did the British Empire claim eastern Australia and declare it terra nullius between 1768 and 1788?*	**Page 3**
Enquiry 02	**The First Fleet & The Convict Penal Colony**	*Whose story do we tell about the founding of the first British penal colony in Australia?*	**Page 4**
Enquiry 03	**Frontier Warfare: Smallpox, Bennelong & Pemulwuy's Resistance**	*Was the colonisation of Australia a story of 'amity and kindness' or violent frontier resistance?*	**Page 5**
Enquiry 04	**The Frontier Wars, Pastoral Expansion & The Black War**	*How did pastoral expansion and frontier conflict transform colonial Australia?*	**Page 6**
Enquiry 05	**The Gold Rush, Eureka Stockade & The Legacy of Colonisation**	*How did the 1851 Gold Rush and the Eureka Stockade transform Australian society and democracy?*	**Page 7**

CORE CONCEPTS Songlines • Terra Nullius • Botany Bay • Penal Colony • Eora Resistance • Pemulwuy • Van Diemen's Land • Black War • Myall Creek • Ballarat Gold Rush • Eureka Stockade • White Australia Policy • Mabo Legacy

CHRONOLOGICAL MILESTONE HIGHWAY • 1770–1901

12 DECISIVE CAUSAL TURNING POINTS • ZERO MAPS MANDATE

1768–1770

Cook, Tupaia & The Myth of Terra Nullius

Ref [1.1–1.5]

Guided across Polynesia by high priest Tupaia, Captain Cook maps the eastern coastline on HMS Endeavour, claiming the territory for King George III under the legal fiction of terra nullius.

Jan 1788

Arrival of the First Fleet at Sydney Cove

Ref [2.1–2.3]

Governor Arthur Phillip lands 11 ships carrying roughly 750 convicts and marines at Sydney Cove, raising the Union Jack to found Britain's first Australian penal colony.

Apr 1789

The Sydney Basin Smallpox Catastrophe (Gal-galla)

Ref [3.1–3.2]

A devastating smallpox epidemic sweeps through the Sydney Basin, killing between 50% and 70% of the local Eora population and obliterating Indigenous clan leadership.

Nov 1789

Abduction of Woollarawarre Bennelong

Ref [3.2–3.3]

Phillip captures Bennelong to act as an imperial cultural mediator; though Bennelong visits London, the cross-cultural alliance collapses as settlement expands.

1797–1802

Pemulwuy's Resistance & The Battle of Parramatta

Ref [3.4–3.5]

Bidjigal resistance leader Pemulwuy leads 100 warriors in a direct daytime assault on colonial troops during a 12-year guerrilla war defending country until his death in 1802.

Mar 1804

Castle Hill Convict Rebellion (Vinegar Hill)

Ref [2.5, 4.1]

Over 200 predominantly Irish convicts stage an armed uprising outside Sydney demanding return to Ireland, but are swiftly routed by the New South Wales Corps at Rouse Hill.

1824–1828

Pastoral Expansion & Martial Law in Van Diemen's Land

Ref [4.1–4.3]

Merino sheep pastoralists seize fertile inland hunting grounds; mounting settler-Indigenous clashes prompt Governor George Arthur to declare martial law, unleashing the Black War.

Oct–Nov 1830

Governor Arthur's 'Black Line' Military Operation

Ref [4.2–4.3]

Over 2,200 soldiers, settlers, and convicts form an unbroken human cordon across Tasmania to drive surviving Aboriginal clans into the Tasman Peninsula, capturing only two people.

10 June 1838

The Myall Creek Massacre & Landmark Trials

Ref [4.4–4.5]

Eleven white stockmen brutally murder 28 unarmed Wirrayaraay women, children, and elders; seven perpetrators are convicted and hanged in an unprecedented colonial court trial.

May 1851

Australian Gold Rush Ignites at Ophir & Ballarat

Ref [5.1–5.2]

Edward Hargraves announces payable gold in NSW, followed by rich Victorian strikes that attract 600,000 global migrants and triple Australia's population within a decade.

3 Dec 1854

The Eureka Stockade Battle at Ballarat

Ref [5.2–5.3]

Gold miners rebel against corrupt police licence hunts under the Southern Cross flag; though crushed militarily in 20 minutes, the rebellion catalyzes universal male suffrage in Victoria.

1 Jan 1901

Australian Federation & The White Australia Policy

Ref [5.4–5.5]

The six self-governing colonies unite into the Commonwealth of Australia, immediately passing the Immigration Restriction Act to institutionalize racial exclusion and disenfranchise First Nations peoples.

ENQUIRY 01 PILLAR 1 • CORE DISCIPLINARY NARRATIVE

CLAIMING AUSTRALIA: CAPTAIN COOK, TUPAIA & THE MYTH OF TERRA NULLIUS

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION: *Why did the British Empire claim eastern Australia and declare it terra nullius between 1768 and 1788?*

[1.1] THE SECRET ADMIRALTY ORDERS (1768–1769)

Why did the British Admiralty issue secret imperial instructions to Captain Cook?

In 1768, Lieutenant James Cook sailed aboard HMS *Endeavour* on an Enlightenment voyage funded by the Royal Society. Officially, Cook was tasked with transporting astronomer Joseph Banks to Tahiti to observe the rare transit of Venus across the Sun.

However, Cook carried locked secret Admiralty orders commanding him to sail south into uncharted Pacific waters. The British Crown ordered Cook to search for the legendary Great Southern Land (*Terra Australis*) and claim the territory for King George III before rival European empires could discover it.

[1.2] TUPAIA AND POLYNESIAN STAR NAVIGATION (1769–1770)

How did Tupaia's navigational mastery enable the Endeavour to reach New Zealand and Australia?

Navigating the vast Pacific required extraordinary expertise that European charts lacked. In Tahiti, Cook enlisted Tupaia, an Arioi high priest and master navigator whose Indigenous guidance proved indispensable to the British expedition.

Using traditional Polynesian non-instrument navigation, Tupaia read star movements, oceanic swells, bird flight paths, and cloud reflections to guide the ship safely across treacherous waters. Tupaia drafted an astonishing navigational chart showing over 130 Pacific islands across thousands of miles, while acting as an essential translator when meeting Māori communities in New Zealand.

[1.3] THE GWEAGAL ENCOUNTER AT BOTANY BAY (APRIL 1770)

How did the Dharawal and Gweagal warriors defend their ancestral lands at Botany Bay?

In April 1770, the *Endeavour* anchored in Botany Bay. As British rowing boats approached the shoreline, two Gweagal warriors of the Dharawal nation marched down to confront the strangers, defending their sacred country.

Following ancient defensive spear protocol, the warriors shouted warnings and brandished weapons to forbid entry. Interpreting this territorial defiance as unprovoked aggression, Cook responded with British musket fire, wounding one warrior in the leg. The Gweagal retreated behind the coastal dunes, leaving the landing party to plant the British flag under armed force.

[1.4] POSSESSION ISLAND & THE ROYAL CLAIM (AUGUST 1770)

Why did Captain Cook claim eastern Australia on Possession Island without a treaty?

Cook surveyed the eastern coastline for four months, navigating dangerous coral reefs along the Queensland coast. In August 1770, Cook landed on a rocky Torres Strait island off Cape York that he named Possession Island.

In full naval uniform, Cook hoisted the Union Jack flag and fired three volleys of musketry to formalise his New South Wales claim for King George III. In doing so, Cook violated his explicit Admiralty instructions, which strictly ordered him to take possession of new territories only with the consent of the native population.

[1.5] THE LEGAL FICTION OF TERRA NULLIUS (1770–1788)

How did the legal fiction of terra nullius justify British dispossession of First Nations peoples?

Cook justified seizing the continent by describing First Nations peoples as primitive nomads who did not farm or construct towns. British jurists used these flawed accounts to declare the continent *terra nullius*—land belonging to nobody.

Under 18th-century European property law, legal sovereignty required fences, iron ploughs, and permanent towns. Because the British recognized no Indigenous ownership, there were no treaties signed with clan elders. This catastrophic legal fiction initiated over two centuries dispossession, stripping Aboriginal nations of ancestral land, legal sovereignty, and basic human rights.

ENQUIRY 02 PILLAR 1 • CORE DISCIPLINARY NARRATIVE

THE FIRST FLEET & THE CONVICT PENAL COLONY

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION: *Whose story do we tell about the founding of the first British penal colony in Australia?*

[2.1] THE AMERICAN CRISIS & THE THAMES PRISON HULKS (1783–1786)

Why did the loss of the American colonies force Britain to establish a penal colony in Australia?

For decades, Britain transported thousands of convicted felons to work on American plantations. However, the loss of American colonies after the 1783 War of Independence abruptly closed this transatlantic penal outlet, creating an acute prison crisis across Britain.

Under the harsh Bloody Code, British county jails overflowed with minor property offenders. Parliament converted rotting Thames hulks into floating prisons, where convicts suffered horrific typhus & overcrowding in disease-ridden holds. Desperate to relieve London's crowded river hulks, Prime Minister William Pitt decided to establish a distant penal colony at Botany Bay.

[2.2] OUTFITTING THE FIRST FLEET (MAY 1787 – JAN 1788)

How did Captain Arthur Phillip manage the 15,000-mile voyage of the First Fleet?

In May 1787, Captain Arthur Phillip was appointed Governor of New South Wales and commanded to assemble the First Fleet. Phillip prepared a convoy of 11 sailing ships carrying over 750 convicts & 250 marines to guard them.

The expedition sailed an arduous 15,000 miles via Cape Town and Rio de Janeiro across treacherous, uncharted oceans over eight months. Through Phillip's strict hygiene, clean drinking water, and ventilation standards, fewer than fifty convicts died during the voyage—an astonishing maritime achievement for eighteenth-century navigation.

[2.3] FOUNDING SYDNEY COVE (JANUARY 1788)

Why did Governor Phillip abandon Botany Bay and establish the settlement at Sydney Cove?

In January 1788, the fleet reached its destination. Phillip was dismayed to discover an open, unprotected Botany Bay offering swampy land, shallow anchorages, and no reliable river for a permanent settlement.

Phillip immediately sailed north in small rowing boats to scout alternative bays, discovering Port Jackson deep water anchorages that formed the finest natural harbour in the world. Landing at Sydney Cove beside a fresh water stream, marines cleared eucalyptus trees, raised the British flag on 26 January 1788, and officially founded New South Wales.

[2.4] THE STARVATION YEARS (1788–1790)

What factors pushed the early settlement at Sydney Cove to the brink of starvation?

The nascent penal colony plunged into desperate hardship during its first two years. Most convicts were urban thieves and weavers lacking agricultural skills, and the settlement struggled against sandy unproductive soil that ruined English seed grain.

Primitive farming tools snapped on tough native tree roots, leaving broken farming hoes useless in rocky ground. Famine worsened when the shipwreck of HMS Guardian on an Antarctic iceberg destroyed vital food supplies. Facing imminent starvation, Phillip slashed rations to subsistence levels and sent convicts to fertile Norfolk Island to survive.

[2.5] CONVICT LABOUR, THE LASH & EMANCIPISTS (1788–1792)

How did the system of convict labour balance severe punishment with the prospect of freedom?

Under Governor Phillip, Sydney was run as a disciplined open-air prison. Convicts endured exhausting dawn-to-dusk labour clearing bush, quarrying sandstone, and building storehouses, while guards enforced order using the brutal cat-o'-nine-tails lash for drunkenness or insolence.

However, Phillip also recognized that incentive encouraged industry. The governor awarded 30-acre land grants to industrious emancipists who completed their sentences. Former convict James Ruse successfully cultivated wheat and corn at Rose Hill, proving Australian soil could sustain British farming and leading the penal colony toward eventual agricultural self-sufficiency.

ENQUIRY 03 PILLAR 1 • CORE DISCIPLINARY NARRATIVE

FRONTIER WARFARE: SMALLPOX, BENNELONG & PEMULWUY'S RESISTANCE

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION: *Was the colonisation of Australia a story of 'amity and kindness' or violent frontier resistance?*

[3.1] FIRST NATIONS CUSTODIANSHIP (PRE-1788)

How did First Nations peoples manage and govern their lands before 1788?

For over 65,000 years, First Nations peoples lived across Australia in the world's oldest continuous civilization. More than 250 language nations occupied distinct ancestral territories, ranging from the coastal Eora clans around Sydney to desert nations of the arid interior.

Aboriginal societies managed ecosystems through sophisticated fire-stick farming, deliberately burning dry grasslands to prevent catastrophic bushfires and regenerate fresh grazing for wallabies. Communities were governed by ancient Songlines & custodianship, spiritual tracks that connected ancestral dreaming, complex customary law, moral obligations, and navigational routes across country.

[3.2] THE 1789 SMALLPOX CATASTROPHE

What was the impact of the 1789 smallpox epidemic on the Eora people of Sydney?

Early contact between British colonists and local clans quickly turned tense as Europeans cleared sacred bush, depleted fish stocks, and contaminated freshwater creeks. In April 1789, an apocalyptic epidemic of gal-galla smallpox struck First Nations communities.

Having no natural biological immunity, local clans suffered devastating 50–70% Eora mortality within weeks. Corpses floated in Sydney Harbour, and survivors abandoned infected campsites in terror. The catastrophic loss of elders & law wiped out vital knowledge, sacred stories, and community leaders, crippling Aboriginal social cohesion and ability to resist British expansion.

[3.3] BENNELONG: THE TRAGIC INTERMEDIARY

Why did Bennelong act as a cultural intermediary between the British and the Eora?

Seeking to establish communication with local clans, Governor Phillip ordered Aboriginal men captured. In late 1789, Wangal warrior Bennelong was kidnapped by marines and held at Government House, where he learned English and adopted European dress.

Bennelong acted as an indispensable cultural mediator between Phillip and Indigenous leaders, negotiating peaceful meetings. In 1792, Bennelong accompanied Phillip to England on a celebrated London voyage 1793, meeting King George III. Returning to Sydney, Bennelong found himself alienated from both British officials and his own people, remaining tragically trapped between two worlds.

[3.4] PEMULWUY: THE RAINBOW WARRIOR (1790–1797)

How did Pemulwuy lead Indigenous armed resistance against British expansion?

While some leaders attempted diplomacy, others launched armed resistance against colonial invasion. Pemulwuy, a revered Bidjigal clan leader, united diverse Aboriginal groups across the Sydney Basin into a coordinated guerrilla resistance movement against European expansion.

Pemulwuy's warriors ambushed British soldiers, speared convict cattle thieves, and retaliated against land theft by burning settler farms and destroying grain stores. In 1797, Pemulwuy led a daylight raid during the Battle of Parramatta (1797), facing British redcoats directly. Though shot multiple times, Pemulwuy survived and escaped hospital, earning legendary status among his people.

[3.5] THE HAWKESBURY RIVER FRONTIER WAR (1795–1802)

Why did the Hawkesbury River expansion lead to protracted frontier warfare?

By the late 1790s, the frontier shifted to the Hawkesbury River. Expanding fertile farming invasions drove Dharug and Bidjigal families away from rich yam beds and fishing grounds, sparking bloody guerrilla warfare as warriors attacked isolated farmhouses.

Governor Philip Gidley King outlawed Indigenous warriors, issuing ruthless shoot on sight orders that permitted settlers and redcoats to kill Aboriginal people without trial. The resistance suffered a fatal blow with the death of Pemulwuy (1802) in an ambush. Pemulwuy's severed head was shipped to London, ending the first organised frontier war.

ENQUIRY 04 PILLAR 1 • CORE DISCIPLINARY NARRATIVE

THE FRONTIER WARS, PASTORAL EXPANSION & THE BLACK WAR

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION: *How did pastoral expansion and frontier conflict transform colonial Australia?*

[4.1] THE INVASION OF VAN DIEMEN'S LAND (1803–1824)

Why did the British settlement of Van Diemen's Land trigger violent conflict with the Palawa people?

In 1803, the British Crown established a secondary penal colony in Van Diemen's Land (modern Tasmania) to deter French expansion. British authorities transported repeat convicts and soldiers to an island home to around 6,000 Indigenous Palawa people.

Violence erupted in May 1804 when British soldiers opened Risdon Cove cannon fire upon three hundred Palawa hunters on a traditional kangaroo hunt. As pastoral sheep farmers seized fertile Palawa hunting grounds across the Tasmanian Midlands, conflict escalated into two decades of bloody retaliation, kidnapping of Aboriginal women, and frontier warfare.

[4.2] THE BLACK WAR & GOVERNOR ARTHUR'S MARTIAL LAW (1826–1830)

How did Governor Arthur's martial law and the 'Black Line' escalate the Black War?

By the late 1820s, Palawa guerrilla resistance threatened British settlement across Tasmania. In response, Governor Arthur martial law was declared in 1828, authorising British forces and armed settlers to shoot Aboriginal people on sight throughout settled districts.

In October 1830, Arthur mobilised 2,200 armed men in a massive human cordon. Over seven weeks, the Black Line sweeps south across the island to drive surviving Palawa into the Tasman Peninsula. Costing £30,000, the operation was a tactical failure, capturing only two Palawa as warriors slipped through the dragnet.

[4.3] TRUGANINI AND THE EXILE TO WYBALENNA (1830–1835)

Why was the relocation of the Palawa to Wybalenna on Flinders Island catastrophic?

Seeking to end the conflict without military humiliation, British missionary George Augustus Robinson enlisted Truganini peacemaking diplomacy. A Nuenonne woman whose family had been murdered by settlers, Truganini persuaded surviving Palawa clans to accept government protection.

However, British authorities betrayed the agreement. Around 200 exiled to Flinders Island were imprisoned in the damp, windswept settlement of Wybalenna. Plagued by depression, poor diet, and Wybalenna camp sickness, over 150 Palawa died within a decade, making Truganini an enduring symbol of tragic Palawa survival and resistance against imperial extermination.

[4.4] SQUATTERS AND THE GREAT MERINO LAND GRAB (1820–1838)

How did the Merino wool boom drive violent frontier expansion across the Australian interior?

On the Australian mainland, economic forces drove an immense land grab across New South Wales and Victoria. Industrial revolution in Britain created soaring Yorkshire wool demand, making fine Australian sheep fleece exceptionally valuable for northern textile mills.

Wealthy colonial pastoralists, known as squatters, pushed millions of Merino sheep flocks across the Blue Mountains into the interior. Squatters seized Indigenous country, fencing creeks and seizing native waterholes for livestock. Sheep devastated native yam daisy fields, destroying Aboriginal food supplies and triggering bitter guerrilla raids as starving clans speared grazing livestock.

[4.5] THE MYALL CREEK RECKONING (1838)

Why was the 1838 Myall Creek trial an unprecedented turning point in colonial Australian law?

In June 1838, frontier brutality culminated in the Myall Creek Massacre. A gang of eleven white stockmen attacked a peaceful camp of unresisting Aboriginal people, leaving 28 Wirrayaraay murdered in cold blood before burning their corpses.

Governor George Gipps ordered a relentless investigation, conducting two trials in Sydney that resulted in 7 white stockmen hanged for murder. This landmark verdict provoked furious squatter outrage & secrecy across colonial newspapers, ensuring future frontier massacres were hidden from colonial authorities behind a code of rural settler silence.

ENQUIRY 05 PILLAR 1 • CORE DISCIPLINARY NARRATIVE

THE GOLD RUSH, EUREKA STOCKADE & THE LEGACY OF COLONISATION

KEY ENQUIRY QUESTION: *How did the 1851 Gold Rush and the Eureka Stockade transform Australian society and democracy?*

[5.1] GOLD FEVER: BALLARAT & BENDIGO (1851–1853)

How did the 1851 gold discoveries transform Australia from a penal colony into an economic powerhouse?

In February 1851, Edward Hargraves announced his landmark Hargraves 1851 discovery of payable alluvial gold near Bathurst, New South Wales. Within months, vastly richer goldfields were found at Ballarat and Bendigo in Victoria, sparking one of the greatest mass migrations in imperial history.

Over half a million prospectors poured into Australia from Europe, America, and China. As gold fever gripped the colonies, the Australian population triples to 1.2m within a decade. Massive gold exports stimulated commerce and railways, financing magnificent Melbourne Victorian wealth that turned Melbourne into one of the British Empire's grandest metropolises.

[5.2] THE GOLD COMMISSION & LICENCE HUNTS (1853–1854)

Why did the monthly miner's licence fee provoke widespread outrage among the gold diggers?

To fund colonial administration and control unruly diggers, Victorian authorities imposed a compulsory 30-shilling monthly fee for a mining licence, whether prospectors found gold or dug empty shafts.

Corrupt colonial police enforced the tax through armed police digger hunts, handcuffing miners who could not produce paperwork on demand and chaining them to trees. Miners deeply resented paying heavy taxes while having no political vote, denouncing this oppression as tyrannical taxation without representation and organising mass protest rallies at Bakery Hill in Ballarat.

[5.3] THE EUREKA STOCKADE (3 DECEMBER 1854)

What was the significance of the 1854 Eureka Stockade for the development of Australian democracy?

In late 1854, Ballarat miners formed the Reform League and built a wooden stockade at Eureka. Swearing an oath under the blue silk Southern Cross flag, diggers pledged to defend their civil liberties against military tyranny.

At dawn on 3 December 1854, nearly three hundred redcoats stormed the camp. A brutal 15-minute dawn assault crushed the rebellion, killing twenty-two diggers. However, public sympathy forced Victorian authorities to abolish mining licences and introduce democratic reforms, including the secret ballot & universal suffrage that founded modern Australian democracy.

[5.4] CHINESE MINERS & THE WHITE AUSTRALIA POLICY (1855–1901)

How did anti-Chinese hostility on the goldfields lead directly to the 1901 White Australia Policy?

The gold rush attracted over 40,000 Chinese diggers, who worked cooperatively re-washing abandoned claims with great success. European miners reacted with intense racial hostility, accusing Chinese workers of stealing water, driving down wages, and introducing foreign vices.

Simmering racism exploded into violence during the Lambing Flat Riots (1861), where white mobs assaulted Chinese miners and destroyed camps. When Australian colonies federated in 1901, the new federal parliament passed the 1901 Immigration Restriction Act, creating the White Australia Policy and using language dictation tests to exclude non-European migrants.

[5.5] FIRST NATIONS SURVIVAL & THE MABO LEGACY (1901–PRESENT)

How did the 1938 Day of Mourning and the 1992 Mabo Decision reshape modern Australian history?

Federation excluded Indigenous Australians from citizenship and national censuses, entrenching state child removals that created the Stolen Generations truth. Yet First Nations leaders continued fighting relentlessly for civil rights and constitutional recognition.

On 26 January 1938, Aboriginal activists held a historic 1938 Day of Mourning in Sydney to protest 150 years of dispossession. Sixty years later, a landmark legal victory occurred when the High Court's 1992 Mabo overturns terra nullius ruling legally recognized Native Title, finally demolishing the legal myth of an empty continent.

MASTER DISCIPLINARY RETRIEVAL ENGINE

MASTER KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL QUIZ

Standard Recall Protocol: 25 core retrieval questions testing factual mastery across all five enquiries. Use for low-stakes weekly partner testing, silent memory flash-checks, or end-of-unit homework retrieval. (Answers verified in textbook narrative; zero answers printed.)

ENQUIRY 1: CLAIMING AUSTRALIA: COOK, TUPAIA & TERRA NULLIUS (1768–1770)

Page 3 • Ref [1.1]–[1.5]

1. What was the public scientific purpose of Captain Cook's 1768 Endeavour voyage to Tahiti?
2. What secret orders was Captain Cook given by the British Admiralty to execute after Tahiti?
3. Who was Tupaia, and how did his Polynesian navigation skills assist the Endeavour expedition?
4. Where did Captain Cook formally claim the eastern coast of Australia for King George III in August 1770?
5. What did the legal doctrine of terra nullius mean in British colonial law, and why was it applied?

ENQUIRY 2: THE FIRST FLEET & THE CONVICT PENAL COLONY (1783–1792)

Page 4 • Ref [2.1]–[2.5]

1. Why could Britain no longer transport convicted felons to North America after 1783?
2. What were the prison hulks moored along the River Thames and southern English naval ports?
3. On what exact date did Governor Arthur Phillip land at Sydney Cove and raise the Union Jack?
4. Why was the early penal settlement at Sydney Cove pushed to the brink of mass starvation in 1788–1790?
5. What was an 'emancipist' in colonial Australian society, and what rights did they possess?

ENQUIRY 3: FRONTIER WARFARE: SMALLPOX, BENNELONG & PEMULWUY (1788–1802)

Page 5 • Ref [3.1]–[3.5]

1. Approximately how long have First Nations peoples lived continuously across the Australian continent?
2. What was the catastrophic impact of the April 1789 smallpox epidemic (gal-galla) on the Sydney Eora?
3. Who was Woollarawarre Bennelong, and why did Governor Phillip capture and detain him in November 1789?
4. Which Bidjigal resistance warrior led a twelve-year guerrilla war against British expansion across Sydney?
5. What lethal proclamation did Governor King issue in November 1801 regarding Parramatta Indigenous clans?

ENQUIRY 4: THE FRONTIER WARS, PASTORAL EXPANSION & BLACK WAR (1803–1840)

Page 6 • Ref [4.1]–[4.5]

1. What was the island of Tasmania officially named during early British colonial rule until 1856?
2. What was Governor George Arthur's 'Black Line' military operation in Tasmania in October–November 1830?
3. Where were surviving Aboriginal Tasmanians exiled in the 1830s under George Augustus Robinson's scheme?
4. Why were wealthy pastoralists who seized vast inland Indigenous territories known as 'squatters'?
5. Why was the December 1838 Myall Creek massacre trial historically unprecedented in colonial Australia?

ENQUIRY 5: THE GOLD RUSH, EUREKA STOCKADE & FEDERATION (1851–1901)

Page 7 • Ref [5.1]–[5.5]

1. What was the immediate demographic and economic effect of the 1851 Australian Gold Rush?
2. What major financial and civil grievance sparked the 1854 Eureka Stockade rebellion in Ballarat?
3. What flag did the rebel miners swear allegiance to on Bakery Hill before the Eureka Stockade battle?
4. What was the White Australia Policy established by the 1901 Immigration Restriction Act?
5. What did the landmark 1992 Mabo Decision achieve in Australian High Court constitutional law?

The History Revision Hub • All Rights Reserved